

Taint Shared Content

Adversaries may deliver payloads to remote systems by adding content to shared storage locations, such as network drives or internal code repositories. Content stored on network drives or in other shared locations may be tainted by adding malicious programs, scripts, or exploit code to otherwise valid files. Once a user opens the shared tainted content, the malicious portion can be executed to run the adversary's code on a remote system. Adversaries may use tainted shared content to move laterally.

A directory share pivot is a variation on this technique that uses several other techniques to propagate malware when users access a shared network directory. It uses [Shortcut Modification](#) of directory .LNK files that use [Masquerading](#) to look like the real directories, which are hidden through [Hidden Files and Directories](#). The malicious .LNK-based directories have an embedded command that executes the hidden malware file in the directory and then opens the real intended directory so that the user's expected action still occurs. When used with frequently used network directories, the technique may result in frequent reinfections and broad access to systems and potentially to new and higher privileged accounts. ^[1]

Adversaries may also compromise shared network directories through binary infections by appending or prepending its code to the healthy binary on the shared network directory. The malware may modify the original entry point (OEP) of the healthy binary to ensure that it is executed before the legitimate code. The infection could continue to spread via the newly infected file when it is executed by a remote system. These infections may target both binary and non-binary formats that end with extensions including, but not limited to, .EXE, .DLL, .SCR, .BAT, and/or .VBS.

ID: T1080

Sub-techniques: No sub-techniques

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Tactic: [Lateral Movement](#)

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Platforms: Linux, Office Suite, SaaS, Windows, macOS

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Procedure Examples

ID	Name	Description
G0060	BRONZE BUTLER	BRONZE BUTLER has placed malware on file shares and given it the same name as legitimate documents on the share. ^[2]
G1021	Cinnamon Tempest	Cinnamon Tempest has deployed ransomware from a batch file in a network share. ^[3]
S0575	Conti	Conti can spread itself by infecting other remote machines via network shared drives. ^{[4][5]}
G0012	Darkhotel	Darkhotel used a virus that propagates by infecting executables stored on shared drives. ^[6]
G0047	Gamaredon Group	Gamaredon Group has injected malicious macros into all Word and Excel documents on mapped network drives. ^[7]
S0132	H1N1	H1N1 has functionality to copy itself to network shares. ^[8]
S0260	InvisiMole	InvisiMole can replace legitimate software or documents in the compromised network with their trojanized versions, in an attempt to propagate itself within the network. ^[9]
S0133	Miner-C	Miner-C copies itself into the public folder of Network Attached Storage (NAS) devices and infects new victims who open the file. ^[10]
S0458	Ramsay	Ramsay can spread itself by infecting other portable executable files on networks shared drives. ^[11]

Mitigations

ID	Mitigation	Description
M1049	Antivirus/Antimalware	Anti-virus can be used to automatically quarantine suspicious files. ^[17]
M1038	Execution Prevention	Identify potentially malicious software that may be used to taint content or may result from it and audit and/or block the unknown programs by using application control ^[18] tools, like AppLocker, ^[19] ^[20] or Software Restriction Policies ^[21] where appropriate. ^[22]
M1050	Exploit Protection	Use utilities that detect or mitigate common features used in exploitation, such as the Microsoft Enhanced Mitigation Experience Toolkit (EMET).
M1022	Restrict File and Directory Permissions	Protect shared folders by minimizing users who have write access.

Detection Strategy

ID	Name	Analytic ID	Analytic Description
DET0471	Detection of Tainted Content Written to Shared Storage	AN1298	Detects adversary tampering of shared directories via file drops (e.g., malicious LNK, EXE, VBS) followed by user execution or suspicious network activity.
		AN1299	Detects script or binary modification within shared NFS/SMB directories followed by process execution from those paths.
		AN1300	Detects modification of shared network folders via .app bundles or scripting files with hidden extensions (e.g., double extensions like docx.app).
		AN1301	Detects upload of malicious or unusual file types into cloud-shared folders, followed by user downloads or interactions.
		AN1302	Detects embedded macros or scripts added to shared documents or use of external references to execute code.

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